Transparency and Responsibility

This session explored the ethical and pedagogical challenges surrounding **transparency, disclosure, and responsibility** in AI use.

Key Findings from Faculty Discussion

- **Erosion of Trust Through Disclosure:** Faculty noted that revealing AI use (e.g., for grading or content generation) often leads to a **decline in student trust** and perceived competence, aligning with research showing that disclosing AI use can reduce credibility and authenticity .
- **When Transparency Helps:** Transparency was seen as **most valuable** in contexts involving **safety, privacy, or technical vulnerabilities**, such as identifying infected libraries or verifying the integrity of datasets and models. In these cases, disclosure enhances protection and collaboration.
- **Limits of Syllabus Disclaimers:** Faculty agreed that **traffic light systems** (e.g., "green/yellow/red" guidelines in syllabus blurbs) are ineffective for communicating appropriate AI use — they lack nuance and often confuse students about expectations.
- **Handling Suspected Misuse:** Discussants expressed discomfort and uncertainty about how to handle potential cases of AI misuse. They questioned whether such issues should remain private or be addressed collectively and emphasized the **time burden** of verifying suspected AI use.
- **Mixed Messages & Pedagogical Coherence:** Faculty worried that policing AI use might unintentionally **promote cheating** by sending mixed messages — emphasizing detection rather than understanding. A consensus emerged that **inquiry-based assignments** may be the best approach, fostering transparency through learning rather than surveillance.

References

Ethical Use of ChatGPT in Education — Best Practices to Combat AI Misuse (Frontiers, 2024) (**link**)

This paper offers comprehensive strategies for ethical AI integration, promoting transparency, attribution, and oversight as essential elements of responsible use.

A Comprehensive AI Policy Education Framework for Universities (Springer, 2023**)** (link)

Calls for institutions to develop clear policies on AI use in teaching and assessment, emphasizing training for faculty on how to address suspected misuse responsibly.

Reassessing Academic Integrity in the Age of AI: A Systematic Review (ScienceDirect, 2025) (link)

Emphasizes the importance of balancing AI's benefits in education with ethical standards, accountability, and verification of AI-generated content before use.

Disclosing AI Use Can Backfire (University of Arizona, 2024) (link)

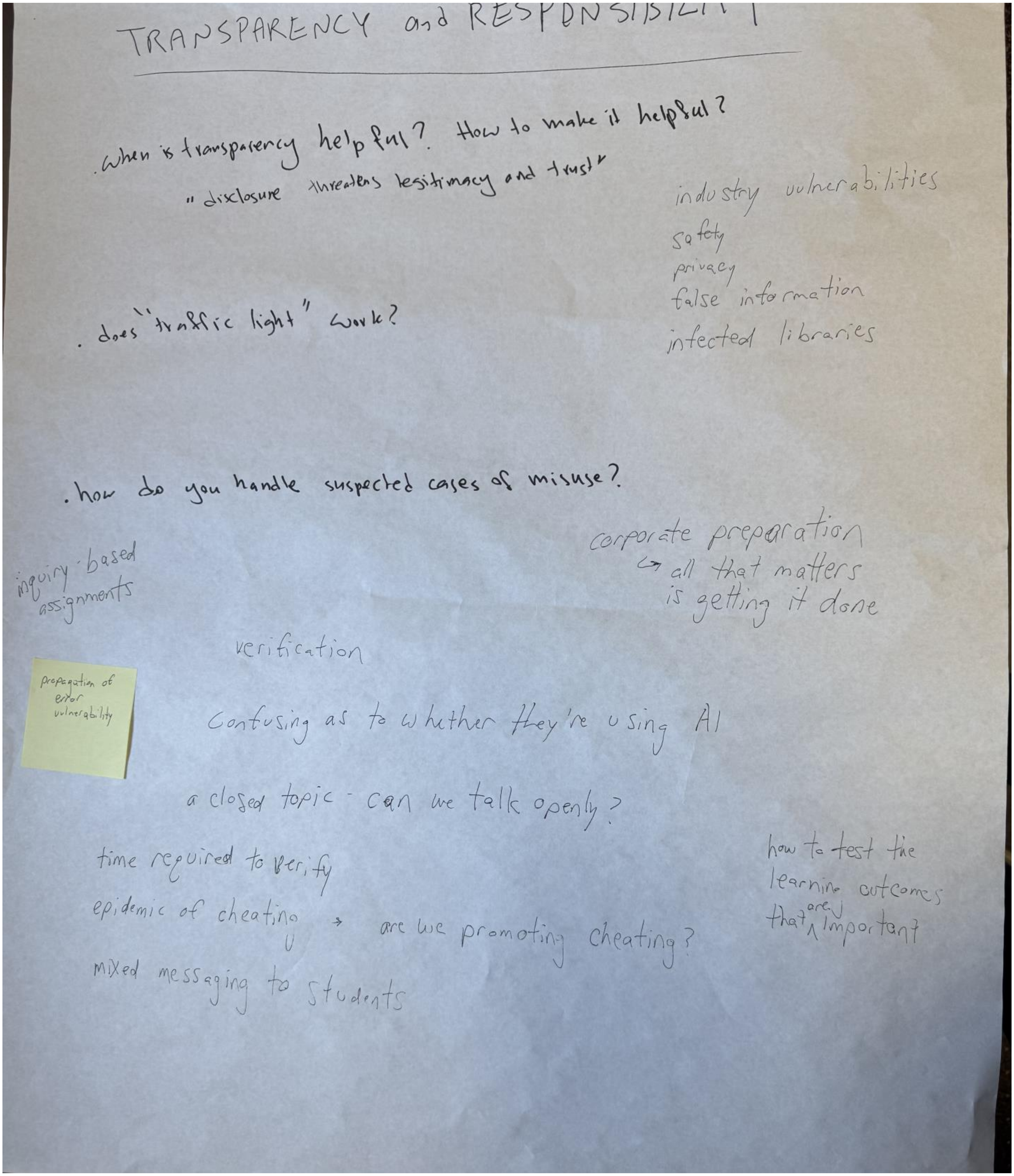
Revealing AI use led to measurable drops in trust, showing that transparency can sometimes reduce perceived credibility and legitimacy.

The Transparency Dilemma: How AI Disclosure Erodes Trust (ScienceDirect, 2025**)** (link)

Disclosing AI usage often erodes trust, as individuals who disclose are perceived as less competent or authentic.

Unravelling Responsibility for AI (arXiv, 2023) (link)

Clarifies overlapping notions of responsibility — moral, causal, and role-based — to help educators determine accountability when AI errors occur.



TRANSPARENCY and RESPONSIBILITY

- when is transparency helpful? How to make it helpful?
  - "disclosure threatens legitimacy and trust"

industry vulnerabilities
safety
privacy
false information
infected libraries

- does "traffic light" work?

- how do you handle suspected cases of misuse?

corporate preparation
↳ all that matters is getting it done

inquiry-based assignments

verification

propagation of error vulnerability

Confusing as to whether they're using AI

a closed topic - can we talk openly?

time required to verify

how to test the learning outcomes that are important

epidemic of cheating → are we promoting cheating?

mixed messaging to students